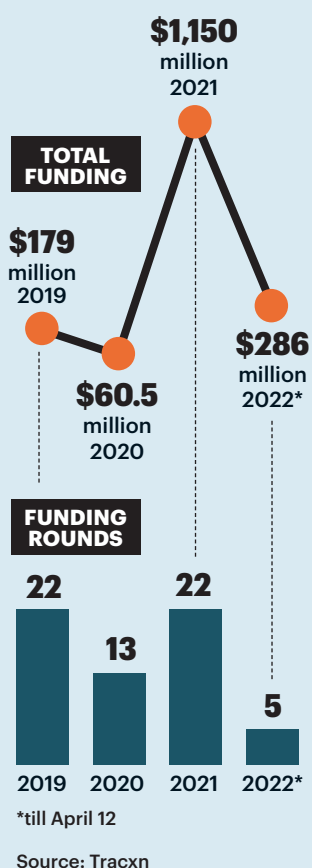


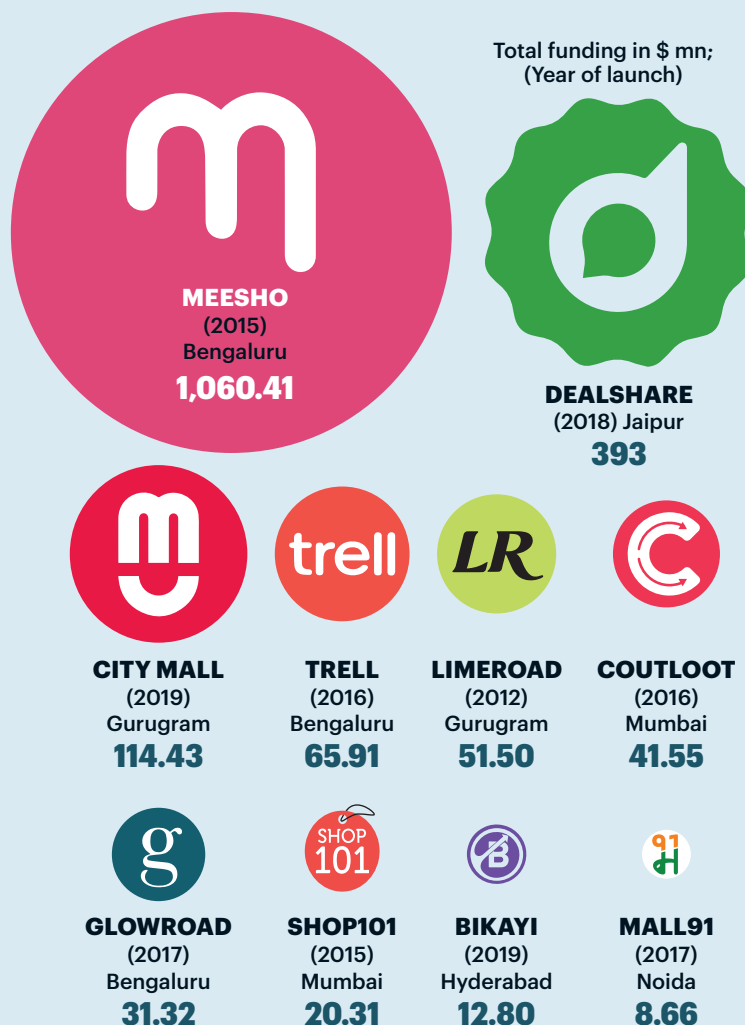
SOCIAL COMMERCE SECTOR FUNDING

While 2021 saw social commerce start-ups receive total funding of \$1,150 million, in 2022 they have already received funding of \$286 million till April 12



TOTAL FUNDING RECEIVED BY THE TOP 10 SOCIAL COMMERCE PLATFORMS IN INDIA

Meesho became the latest entrant in the unicorn club with a valuation of \$2.1 billion after its most recent funding round in April, 2022



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GRAPHICS BY **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

corroborated by the significant jump in the number of sellers that have come on board such platforms in the past couple of years. Small sellers earlier were not very digital savvy but they have been virtually forced to embrace technology, says Chawla.

THE INDIAN TWIST

What is the most common trait of an average Indian shopper? Ask anyone, anywhere in India and the prompt reply would be a love for bargaining.

While online e-commerce has seen a huge jump in

volume and reach, it is all about searching for a product and buying it. There is no human or social element in the whole online shopping experience and that is where social commerce is fast creating a niche.

Indian social commerce players have been quick to understand the average Indian shopper's psyche and consequently added interesting and innovative features to recreate the physical or real-life shopping experience in the digital world.

Coutloom, for instance, has built an automatic bargaining feature on its platform that provides the buyer a